

InfoSec SIG @ KJSSE

FLAG OF THE DAY

FOTD #001 SOLUTION

What you see, is all there is;

CATEGORY	Cryptography
DIFFICULTY	Very Easy
DATE	17/09/2026
FLAG	INFOSEC_SIG{I_w4s_r1ght_h3r3_4ll_4l0ng}

THE BAIT

The description gives you a Base64 string, so the natural first move is to decode it.

```
$ echo "WW91IHJlYWxseSB0aG91Z2h0IGl0IHdvdWxkIGJlIHRobaXMgZWZzeT8KVHJ5IEhhcmRlciB4RA==" \  
  | base64 -d  
You really thought it would be this easy?  
Try Harder xD
```

That one is a decoy. The real flag is hiding somewhere else on the page.

LOOK AGAIN

At first glance the PDF has the header, the details table and the decoy string. Nothing else stands out. Press Ctrl+A to select everything, though, and the highlight picks up a tiny speck sitting just below the decoy string.

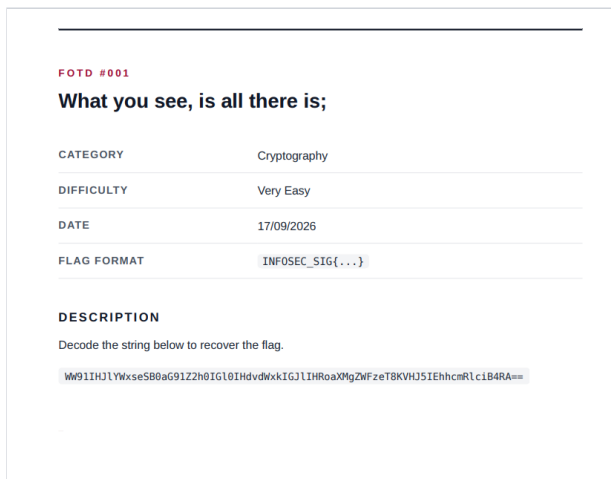


Figure 1. The page as it normally appears.



Figure 2. Ctrl+A shows something under the string.

WHY YOU CAN'T SEE IT

In the source markdown, that text sits inside 20 nested `<sub>` tags. Each tag shrinks the font a bit and drops it lower, so after 20 levels the text is far too small to read. It still exists as real text in the PDF, which means you can copy it like anything else.

PULL IT OUT

Copy the selection and paste it into a plain text editor. Notepad is enough. An extra line appears that was never visible on the page.

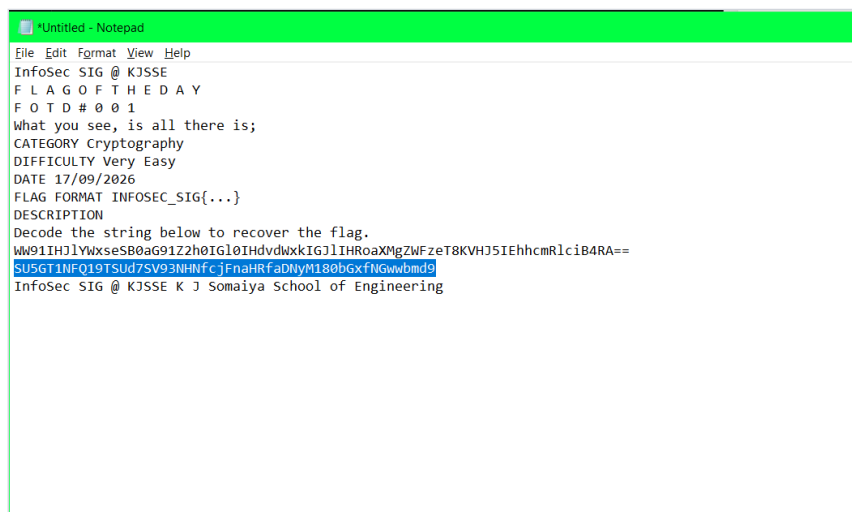


Figure 3. The pasted text, with the hidden string highlighted.

If you prefer the terminal, `pdftotext` gets you the same result:

```
$ pdftotext F0TD-001.pdf -
```

DECODE IT

The hidden string is Base64 as well. Decode it the same way:

```
$ echo "SU5GT1NFQ19TSUd7SV93NHNfcjFnaHRfaDNyM180bGxfNGwwbmd9" | base64 -d  
INFOSEC_SIG{I_w4s_r1ght_h3r3_4l1_4l0ng}
```

Pasting it into Google works too. Be careful with fonts where a lowercase L and the number 1 look identical. The flag ends in `4l1_4l0ng`, and both are Ls.

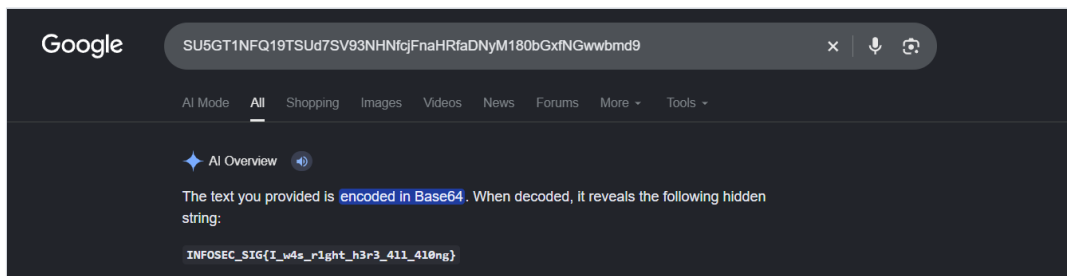


Figure 4. Google decoding the hidden string.

INFOSEC_SIG{I_w4s_r1ght_h3r3_4l1_4l0ng}

TAKEAWAY

The title was the hint, just flipped. A document can hold text you can't see because of its size, colour or position, and that text is still in the file. On any document challenge, select everything or run `pdftotext` before you start decoding.